

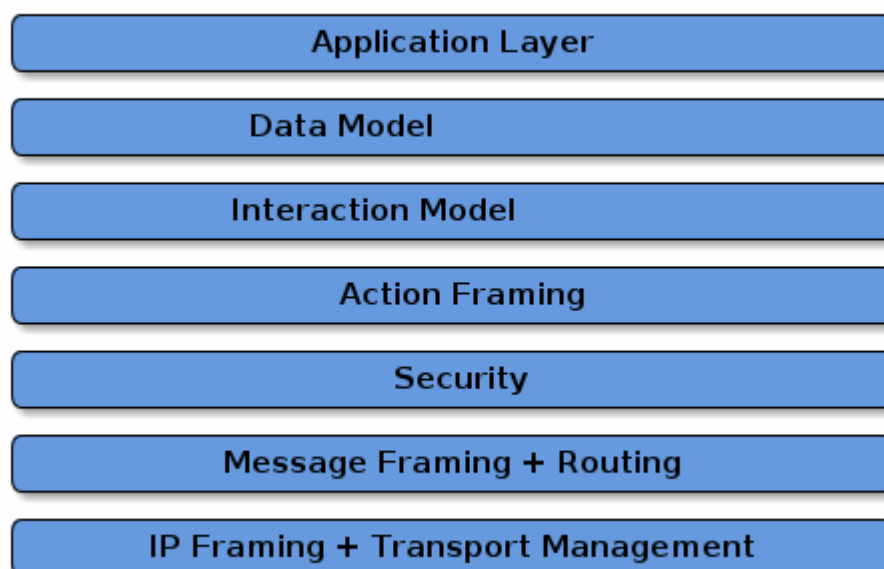


Figure 2. Layered Architecture

The *Application* layer corresponds to the high order business logic of a device. For example, an application that is focused on lighting might contain logic to handle turning on/off a light bulb, as well as its color characteristics.

The *Data Model* layer corresponds to the data and verb elements that help support the functionality of the application. The Application operates on these data structures when there is intent to interact with the device.

The *Interaction Model* layer defines a set of interactions that can be performed between a client and server device. For example, reading or writing attributes on a server device would correspond to application behavior on the device. These interactions operate on the elements defined at the data model layer.

Once an action is constructed using the *Interaction Model*, it is serialized into a prescribed packed binary format to encode for network transmission. This process is handled in the *Action Framing* layer.

An encoded action frame is then processed by the *Security Layer*: the message is encrypted and appended with a message authentication code. These actions ensure the data remain confidential and authentic between sender and receiver of the message.

With an interaction now serialized, encrypted, and signed, the *Message Layer* constructs the payload format with required and optional header fields, which specify properties of the message as well logical routing information.

After the final payload has been constructed by the *Message Layer*, it is sent to the underlying transport protocol (TCP or Matter's [Message Reliability Protocol](#)) for IP management of the data.

Once the data is received on the peer device, it travels up the protocol stack, where the various layers reverse the operations on the data performed by the sender, to finally deliver the message to the Application for consumption.